

■ COMPLETE SPORTS BETTING GLOSSARY

WC 2026 Edition · A-Z of Every Term You Need to Know

— A —

Accumulator (Acca)

A bet combining multiple selections where all must win. Each win multiplies the odds. Typically 4+ selections. Higher risk, higher reward.

Asian Handicap (AH)

A bet type that eliminates draws by giving a virtual head start to the underdog. Most common: AH 0, AH 0.5, AH 1, AH 1.5.

Arbitrage (Arb)

Exploiting different odds at different bookmakers to guarantee a profit regardless of outcome. Legal and risk-free.

Ante-post

A bet placed before an event is imminent — e.g., pre-tournament outright bets. Higher odds, but stake usually lost if your team withdraws.

— B —

Banker

A highly confident selection, often used as the foundation of an accumulator. If the banker loses, the whole bet loses.

Bankroll

Your total betting fund. Never risk more than 5% on a single bet.

Bet Credits

Bonus funds given by sportsbooks that can only be used as stakes, not withdrawn directly.

Both Teams to Score (BTTS)

A market on whether both teams will score at least once. Yes or No.

Bookmaker (Bookie)

A licensed company that accepts bets on sporting events and sets odds.

— C —

Cash Out

A feature allowing you to settle a bet early before the event ends, taking a guaranteed sum in exchange for giving up the potential full win.

Correct Score

Betting on the exact final scoreline. High odds, low probability.

Cover

When a spread bet wins by the required margin (e.g., 'covering the spread' of -1.5 goals).

— D —

Dead Heat

When two or more outcomes finish equal (e.g., two players tied on goals). Stakes are divided by the number of tied participants.

Double Chance

Betting on two of three outcomes — Home or Draw, Away or Draw, or Home or Away. Lower odds, higher probability.

Draw No Bet (DNB)

Bet on home or away win; stake returned if match ends in a draw. AH 0 equivalent.

Dutching

Distributing a total stake across multiple selections so the same profit is made regardless of which one wins.

— E —

Each Way (E/W)

A two-part bet — half on win, half on place. Common in horse racing, less so in football.

Edge

Your mathematical advantage over the bookmaker. A positive edge means your bet is statistically profitable long-term.

Enhanced Odds / Odds Boost

A promotional offer where a bookmaker increases the odds on a specific selection.

Expected Value (EV)

The average amount you expect to win per bet over time. Positive EV = profitable bet.

— F —

Favourite

The team or player most likely to win according to the bookmaker, reflected in shorter odds.

Fixed Odds

Standard pre-match betting where odds are agreed when the bet is placed.

Float

The amount in your betting account available to use.

— G —

Grand Salami

A bet on the total number of goals across all games on a given day's fixture list.

Graded Bet

A bet that has been officially settled — either as a winner, loser, or push.

— H —

Half Time / Full Time (HT/FT)

Predict the result at half time AND full time. E.g. Away/Home = away team leading at HT, home team wins FT.

Handicap Betting

Giving one team a virtual advantage or disadvantage to level the playing field.

Hedge

Placing a bet on the opposite outcome to an existing bet to guarantee a profit or reduce risk.

— I —

In-Play / Live Betting

Betting on an event after it has started. Odds fluctuate in real time based on match events.

Implied Probability

The probability implied by the bookmaker's odds. Formula: $1 \div \text{decimal odds} \times 100$.

— K —

Kelly Criterion

A mathematical formula for calculating optimal bet size based on your edge and odds. Kelly % = $(BP - Q) / B$.

— L —

Lay Bet

Available on exchanges (Betfair). You act as the bookmaker, betting that a selection will NOT win.

Limit

Maximum stake a bookmaker will accept on a given market.

Line

The current odds or point spread on a given market.

Live Odds

Real-time, continuously updated odds during an in-play event.

— M —

Matched Betting

Using bookmaker free bets and bonuses alongside lay bets on exchanges to guarantee profit. Risk-free when done correctly.

Middle

A scenario where the final score or result falls between two opposing bets, resulting in winning both.

Moneyline

Simple win/lose bet with no handicap. American format shows -150 (favourite) or +200 (underdog).

Mug Bet

A losing bet placed intentionally to disguise your activity from the bookmaker and avoid account restrictions.

— O —

Odds Against

When your potential profit exceeds your stake (decimal > 2.00, e.g., 3/1 fractional).

Odds On

When your stake exceeds your potential profit (decimal < 2.00, e.g., 1/2 fractional).

Outright

A bet on the overall winner of a tournament rather than a single match.

Over/Under (O/U)

A bet on whether the total goals (or other metric) will be over or under a set number, e.g., Over 2.5.

— P —

Parlay

American term for accumulator. Multiple selections, all must win.

Puck Line / Run Line / Goal Line

Sport-specific spread equivalents to Asian Handicap.

Push

A result that returns your stake — happens in Asian Handicap when the margin exactly equals the handicap.

— R —

Reverse Asian Handicap

Betting on the underdog with the handicap advantage.

ROI (Return on Investment)

Your net profit as a percentage of total stakes.

Round Robin

A series of accumulators covering all combinations from a group of selections.

— S —

Same Game Parlay (SGP)

Combining multiple markets from the same match into one bet. High odds, high correlation risk.

Sharp

A professional or sophisticated bettor whose bets move the market.

Smart Money

Large bets placed by sharp bettors that cause the line to move.

Spread Betting

Betting on how far above or below a given number an outcome will fall. Profit/loss multiplies with accuracy.

Steam

Rapid market movement when sharp bettors all bet on the same side simultaneously.

— T —

Teaser

A parlay with adjusted point spreads in your favour in exchange for lower odds.

Tissue Price

A bookmaker's internal pre-market odds before they factor in their margin.

Total

The combined score of both teams. Often used for Over/Under betting.

— V —

Value Bet

A bet where the probability of winning is higher than what the odds imply. The cornerstone of profitable betting.

Void Bet

A bet that is cancelled and stakes returned — typically if a match is abandoned or a player doesn't participate.

— W —

Whale

A very high-stakes bettor.

Win Only

A bet that only pays if the selection wins outright (not placed). Contrast with each-way.

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